

WORLD RELIGIONS

OVERVIEW

The study of world religions cultivates an understanding of the roles of religion in contemporary society. World religions courses encourage students to explore the ways in which religions and belief traditions meet various human needs and to examine the significance and function of sacred places, rites, writings, and teachings in diverse world religions and belief traditions.

In the two world religions courses in the social sciences and humanities curriculum, students develop their understanding of the connections between religion and social, ethical, and philosophical issues as well as personal psychological needs and concerns. These courses also examine critical issues facing world religions and their adherents today. Research and inquiry skills are developed throughout the courses as students explore and analyse contemporary and historical issues surrounding world religions.

World Religions and Belief Traditions: Perspectives, Issues, and Challenges, Grade 11

University/College Preparation

HRT3M

This course provides students with opportunities to explore various world religions and belief traditions. Students will develop knowledge of the terms and concepts relevant to this area of study, will examine the ways in which religions and belief traditions meet various human needs, and will learn about the relationship between belief and action. They will examine sacred writings and teachings, consider how concepts of time and place influence different religions and belief traditions, and develop research and inquiry skills related to the study of human expressions of belief.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to world religions and belief traditions, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to world religions and belief traditions (*e.g., government policy pertaining to religion, the use of religious symbols in popular culture*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry
Teacher prompt: “If you were researching the effects of the commercialization of yoga, what are the different points of view that you should consider?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research
Teacher prompts: “What are some ways to locate reliable sources of information?” “What criteria can you use to determine whether a particular

website is a reliable source of information?”

“What methods would you use to ensure that you are following ethical guidelines when you develop surveys or interviews?”

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, original research published in peer-reviewed journals, original documents in print or other media – sacred texts, film, photographs, songs, advertisements*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., book reviews, textbooks, websites, brochures, newspaper articles*)

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a research question and identify potential subtopics to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies can you use to determine the relevance of the information you have gathered?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?” “What values

are embedded in the sources?" "Whose voices are represented and whose are absent?" "Whose interests are advanced if you believe the main message of this source?"

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare results of surveys and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., determine whether their results support or contradict their hypothesis; weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., oral presentation, written report, formal debate, poster, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific audience and purpose

A4.2 use terms relating to world religions and belief traditions correctly (*e.g., belief, creed, deity, divine, faith, habit, sacred, tradition, ritual*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow appropriate conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., MLA, Chicago, or Turabian style for references and/or notes*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompts: "What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?" "What questions do you still have?"

B. APPROACHES TO THE STUDY OF THE SACRED

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Why Study World Religions and Belief Traditions?:** demonstrate an understanding of various reasons for the study of world religions and belief traditions;
- B2. Terms and Concepts in the Study of the Sacred:** demonstrate an understanding of terms and concepts related to the study of world religions and belief traditions;
- B3. Approaches:** demonstrate an understanding and assess the strengths and weaknesses of various approaches to the study of world religions and belief traditions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Why Study World Religions and Belief Traditions?

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify diverse religions and belief traditions that are found in Canada (*e.g., Christianity, First Nation and Inuit ritual and spirituality, Hinduism, Islam, Jainism, Judaism, secular humanism*)
- B1.2** identify reasons for the study of world religions and belief traditions (*e.g., to broaden their understanding of the world, to gain insight into human behaviour and diverse perspectives, to identify and explore universal values*)
Teacher prompt: “How does the study of world religions and belief traditions enhance our ability to understand and appreciate diversity? In what ways might the study of world religions reduce our tendency to negatively judge people who are different from ourselves?”
- B1.3** identify and describe local and global contexts in which it is important to have an understanding of diverse religions and belief traditions
Teacher prompts: “In what ways does globalization increase the need for us to learn about the belief traditions of others?” “How does a study of history show us the importance of understanding diverse belief traditions?”

B2. Terms and Concepts in the Study of the Sacred

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** explain the various terms used to classify religions and belief traditions and the values implicit in these classifications (*e.g., belief system, cult, denomination, religion, sect*)
Teacher prompt: “Why might some people say that Buddhism is a philosophy and not a religion? What difference does this make?”
- B2.2** define and appropriately use terms that relate to the study of world religions and belief traditions (*e.g., atheism, agnosticism, ethics, monotheism, pantheism, polytheism, animism, theology*)
- B2.3** explain important concepts related to the study of religions and belief traditions (*e.g., insider-outsider challenge, reductionism versus religionism, thick description*)

B3. Approaches

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify and explain the rationale for at least two recognized conceptual or methodological approaches to the study of religions and belief traditions (*e.g., theological, anthropological, historical, psychological, typological, sociological*)

- B3.2** identify the strengths and limitations of various approaches to the study of religions and belief traditions (*e.g., the historical approach relies primarily on written accounts; anthropological approaches may be influenced by ethnocentrism*)
- B3.3** describe their own perspective on religions and belief traditions
- B3.4** identify biases that may inform their own perspective on religions and belief traditions (*e.g., anthropocentrism, an individualistic rather than a community orientation, a predisposition to value science over faith, a predisposition to privilege written rather than oral sources*)
- B3.5** describe the roles of doubt, faith, intuition, and reason in religions and belief traditions

C. RELIGIOUS AND SPIRITUAL IMPULSE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Functions of Human Belief Traditions:** explain some of the ways people use religions and belief traditions to meet human needs;
- C2. The Search for Meaning:** analyse ways in which various religions and belief traditions conceptualize the journey of life as a spiritual journey and quest for meaning.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Functions of Human Belief Traditions

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** explain the connection between religions/belief traditions and human efforts to understand existence and the nature of reality (*e.g., belief as a way of understanding destiny, the natural world, and ultimate reality*)
- C1.2** explain the ways in which individual human needs (*e.g., for community, meaning and purpose, psychological or emotional security*) can be addressed through religions and belief traditions
- C1.3** explain the ways in which community needs (*e.g., for commemoration, continuity, institutions, order, organization*) can be met through religions and belief traditions

Teacher prompt: “How is the human need to remember and ritualize expressed through organized religion?”

- C1.4** analyse how experiences and practices associated with various belief systems may change over time, and suggest reasons for the changes

Teacher prompts: “Why do some individuals become more religious as they get older?” “How might the commercial image of tobacco affect the way it is perceived within and outside First Nation cultures?” “How can the dietary requirements of Abrahamic religions be observed within the context of a secular school?”

C2. The Search for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** explain how the journey of life can be seen as a quest for meaning, and identify common questions associated with the search for meaning and purpose in life (*e.g., Who are we? Where do we come from?*)

Teacher prompts: “What do you think the meaning or purpose of life is?” “How might your understanding of your life’s purpose change as you get older?”

- C2.2** identify and explain concepts associated with the journey of life and the quest for meaning in various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., karma, jihad, nirvana, vocation, the Jewish covenant, the Aboriginal sacred path*)

Teacher prompts: “How is the individual’s spiritual struggle known as jihad expressed at different moments in a Muslim’s life?” “How does the First Nation concept of walking the sacred path incorporate ideas about physical, emotional, environmental, and spiritual healing?” “How do the concepts of samsara, nirvana, and dharma depict the journey of life?”

- C2.3** explain experiences and practices of various religions and belief systems that are associated with the quest for meaning and/or spiritual understanding (*e.g., ordination, the prayer labyrinth, pilgrimage, the vision quest, practices associated with mysticism*)

Teacher prompts: “How does the rite of passage popularly known as the vision quest

(and practised in different forms by various indigenous peoples) assist seekers to discover their life purpose and meaning?" "What is the significance of ordination in Christian belief?" "What is the significance of the hajj for a Muslim?" "How is a labyrinth a metaphor for the journey of life?" "Why is the river symbolic of the spiritual quest of a Jain?"

C2.4 explain how ideas about death and the afterlife in various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., Chinvat; heaven, hell, and purgatory; nirvana; reincarnation*) reflect conceptions of the spiritual journey in these traditions

Teacher prompts: "What does the attainment of nirvana signify in the life journey of a Buddhist?" "How do the burial practices of various First Nation communities express their understanding of the journey of life?" "How does the idea of life as a covenant signify both the experience of a journey and the arrival at a destination?"

D. SACRED TEACHINGS AND PRINCIPLES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Tenets, Practices, and Teachings:** outline the central tenets, practices, and teachings of various religions and belief traditions;
- D2. Sacred Writings and Oral Teachings:** analyse the role of sacred writings and oral teachings in various religions and belief traditions;
- D3. Prescribed Roles and Influential Figures:** analyse how individuals with specific roles have influenced the development of various religions and belief traditions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Tenets, Practices, and Teachings

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** explain the concept of the supernatural and the role of entities associated with it in various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., angels, avatars, the creator, deities, demons, spirits, saints, souls*)

Teacher prompts: “How do the distinct roles of Allah, Gabriel, and Muhammad reveal the Muslim understanding of the supernatural?” “How does the doctrine of the Communion of Saints reflect the Roman Catholic concept of the supernatural?” “Why do Hindus and Buddhists have different understandings of the roles of Vishnu, Rama, Krishna, and the Buddha?” “How did beliefs about the supernatural influence the decision of the Adivasi, the Aboriginal people of the Narmada River, to protest the construction of a dam?”

- D1.2** identify and explain the central tenets of various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., the Works of Mercy, the Five Virtues, the Golden Rule, the Noble Truths, the Three Jewels, the Code of Handsome Lake*)

- D1.3** describe actions people perform to fulfil the expectations of their particular belief tradition (*e.g., Aboriginal respect for and protection of the environment, charitable giving, zakat*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the duties of Roman Catholics as outlined in the Works of Mercy?” “How might Muslims fulfil the religious obligation of zakat?” “How have First Nation beliefs about the natural world inspired the spawn-on-kelp sustainable fishing industry?”

- D1.4** explain how concepts of time, creation, and the afterlife are reflected in the teachings and practices of various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., karma, samsara and nirvana, sin and salvation*)

Teacher prompts: “How do the concepts of karma, rebirth, and nirvana relate to each other in the world view of a Buddhist?” “How does the Islamic understanding of the afterlife affect the actions of Muslims?” “How do the cultural practices and spiritual beliefs of various First Nations reflect their knowledge and understanding of cyclical processes in nature?”

- D1.5** identify and explain practices that reflect the principles and/or teachings of various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., vegetarianism and ahimsa, baptism and grace, tithing of income for charity and tzedakah, fasting and submission*)

Teacher prompts: “How is the principle of ahimsa (non-violence) reflected in the dietary practices of a Jain?” “Why is the principle of tzedakah (charity) central to Jewish life?”

- D1.6** explain how differing interpretations of specific teachings have arisen within various faith communities (*e.g., interpretations of: the relative importance of scripture and tradition; the role and place of human beings in the world; the relative importance of individual versus community values; succession [in Islam]*)

Teacher prompts: “How did the events surrounding the death of Muhammad result in the formation of the two largest groups within Islam – Sunni and Shi’a?” “How might the Judaeo-Christian understanding of the human person as made in the image and likeness of

God conflict with the first Buddhist precept of ahimsa?” “How is the emphasis on community responsibility over individual rights reflected in First Nation traditions?”

D2. Sacred Writings and Oral Teachings

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** identify significant sacred writings (e.g., the Qur'an, the Mahabharata, the New Testament, the Torah) and oral teachings (e.g., the Code of Handsome Lake, the Seven Grandfather Teachings, the Mishnah) of various religions and belief traditions
- D2.2** explain the origins and development of various sacred writings and oral teachings (e.g., the influence of the political conditions in early Christian communities on the writing of the Gospels; the role and varieties of revelation as a source of teachings and texts)
- Teacher prompt:** “How did the Roman occupation of ancient Palestine influence the events recorded in and writing of the New Testament?”
- D2.3** identify the central principles outlined in key oral teachings and passages of sacred writings in various religions and belief traditions (e.g., the Ten Commandments, the Sermon in the Deer Park, the Sermon on the Mount, Aboriginal creation stories)
- D2.4** compare sacred writings and oral teachings within the same tradition in terms of their recognized importance and influence on believers (e.g., the Qur'an and the Hadith in Islam, the Torah and the Mishnah in Judaism, the Rig Veda and the Laws of Manu in Hinduism)
- Teacher prompts:** “How do the Torah and the Mishnah differ in the way they guide the life of a believer?” “How do differences in authority between the Rig Veda and the Laws of Manu affect how each is used and interpreted by Hindus?”

D3. Prescribed Roles and Influential Figures

By the end of this course, students will:

- D3.1** identify and explain concepts that define the basic roles and/or responsibilities of adherents of various religions and belief traditions (e.g., ahimsa, satya, and tyaga; dharma; love of God and neighbour; submission; re-enactment of the Dreaming through sacred art)
- Teacher prompts:** “How does the concept of dharma influence the conduct of Hindus?” “How is the Christian concept of love of neighbour intended to influence conduct?” “How is the concept of the Dreaming reflected in rituals involving sacred sites and symbols left by the Ancestors?” “What guidelines for ethical conduct are outlined in the Ten Commandments?”
- D3.2** identify and explain the purpose of specific roles associated with various religions and belief traditions (e.g., ascetic, Brahmin, cantor, elder, guru, imam, laity, priest, prophet, senator in the Métis tradition, shaman)
- D3.3** identify influential figures associated with various religions and belief traditions (e.g., Abraham, Jesus of Nazareth, Confucius, Guru Nanak, Mirza Husayn, Ali Nuri, Moses, Mother Ann Lee, Muhammad, Siddhartha Gautama, Zoroaster, Handsome Lake), describe the contexts in which they emerged, and summarize their influence on the particular religion or belief tradition
- D3.4** analyse the impact of leaders and activists associated with various religions and belief traditions (e.g., Dietrich Bonhoeffer, Thich Quang Duc, Mohandas K. Gandhi, Mother Teresa, Martin Luther King Jr., Elie Wiesel, the women of Chipko)
- Teacher prompts:** “Why do both Lutheran and Anglican Christians venerate Pope John XXIII as a ‘renewer of the Church’?” “How did Thich Quang Duc become an example to other Buddhists, and what impact did he have on Buddhism, especially in Vietnam?” “How are the experiences and lessons of the women of Chipko relevant to current global and environmental issues?”

E. RITES AND OBSERVANCE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Daily Living as Sacred Reality:** demonstrate an understanding of the type of daily observances associated with various religions and belief traditions and of the role of these observances in the lives of adherents;
- E2. Rites and Rituals:** demonstrate an understanding of the ways in which rituals and rites reflect the understandings and principles of various religions and belief traditions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Daily Living as Sacred Reality

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** describe the daily practices associated with various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., dietary practices, forms of dress, patterns of prayer, use of language, care for those in need*)
- E1.2** explain how the daily practices of adherents reflect the teachings of their particular religion or belief tradition (*e.g., acts of discernment and/or daily prayer, acts of service, meditation, reflection*)
- E1.3** explain the origins of the daily practices of various religions or belief traditions (*e.g., Salah, Shema, Sikh practices signifying the importance of self-defence, Prayer to the Four Directions*)

Teacher prompts: “How do the practices associated with the Five Ks of Sikhism remind Sikhs of their beliefs?” “In Judaism, what conditions are prescribed for the consumption and preparation of food in Deuteronomy 11?” “How might geography or environment affect the rituals of Prayer to the Four Directions?”

- E1.4** describe how major historical events and movements have shaped the daily practices of various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., ahimsa in satyagraha, the prayer book movement in Anglican Christianity, the residential schools experience for First Nation and Métis people*)

E2. Rites and Rituals

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** describe ways in which various religions and belief traditions use rites and rituals to provide a spiritual context for understanding human experience
Teacher prompt: “How do initiation rites such as baptism, naming ceremonies, and vision quests reflect and sustain the values of specific communities?”
- E2.2** explain the origin and significance of various belief-related rituals, symbols, and festivals (*e.g., the Five Ks, ICHTHYS, puja, sounding the shofar during Rosh Hashanah, the medicine wheel*)

Teacher prompts: “What are some explanations of the origin of the acronym ICHTHYS as a symbol for Christianity?” “Why is the medicine wheel a common symbol used in contemporary First Nation art and culture?” “How does the experience of Guru Arjan Dev, including his martyrdom, reinforce the importance of the Five Ks for Sikhs?”

- E2.3** classify rituals and practices of various religions and belief systems in terms of categories such as almsgiving, asceticism, atonement, anointing, calls to worship, covenant, dietary laws, sacrifice, holy days, vision quest

E2.4 describe how major historical events and movements have shaped the rituals of various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., the Passover seder, the Blackfoot sun dance, the potlatch*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways has contact with Europeans changed the potlatch ritual over the past two centuries?” “How are the events of the book of Exodus reflected in various aspects of the Passover ceremony?” “How was the practice of Shinto, particularly State Shinto, affected by the Second World War?”

E2.5 explain how key teachings of various religions and belief systems are reflected in their rites of passage (*e.g., rites associated with birth, coming of age, marriage, death and funerary practices*)

Teacher prompts: “How does cremation after death reflect Hindu beliefs about the afterlife and reincarnation?” “Why are there different expectations of participants in the rituals of baptism and confirmation?”

F. SOCIAL AND CULTURAL CONTEXTS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- F1. Cultural Contexts:** identify and analyse ways in which various religions and belief traditions are embodied in cultural forms;
- F2. Social Contexts:** analyse the interaction between society and various religions and belief traditions;
- F3. Social Challenges:** demonstrate an understanding of the challenges that adherents of various religions and belief systems experience in society;
- F4. Religion, Civil Society, and Popular Culture:** describe and analyse ways in which various religions and belief traditions are interpreted and adapted within civil society and popular culture.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

F1. Cultural Contexts

By the end of this course, students will:

- F1.1** identify and explain the significance of signs and symbols associated with various religions and belief traditions (*e.g., the crucifix, the medicine wheel, symbols for the syllable “om”*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is the crucifix, which was an instrument of Roman torture, employed as a sign of salvation by Christians?” “How do the colours in a medicine wheel embody the First Nation concept of the importance of the physical, spiritual, and natural worlds?” “Why is the syllable ‘om’ sacred to Hindus?”

- F1.2** explain why different religions and belief systems prohibit particular cultural forms or activities (*e.g., reasons for: the iconoclastic controversy, prohibitions against visual depictions in Judaism and Islam, the common practice of not preserving sand mandalas within Tibetan Buddhism*)

Teacher prompt: “Why are sand mandalas often swept away upon completion?”

- F1.3** analyse the ways in which various religions and belief traditions are reflected in specific works of art, architecture, music, literature, and dance; in styles of dress; and in cuisines (*e.g., religious icons, La Sagrada Familia church by Antonio Gaudi, evening ragas, the poetry of Rumi, Bharatnatyam dance, monastic robes, kosher and vegetarian cooking, the architecture of Douglas Cardinal*)

Teacher prompts: “How do the architectural features of La Sagrada Familia church reflect aspects of the Roman Catholic faith?” “How do the cuisines of various cultures reflect the dietary laws of particular religions?” “How are Aboriginal attitudes towards the environment and geography reflected in the architecture of Douglas Cardinal?”

- F1.4** explain why certain cultural forms have special significance within particular religions and belief traditions (*e.g., Aboriginal drumming, Gregorian chant, Hindu sculpture, Islamic calligraphy, statues of the Buddha, Odissi dance and music*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is drumming important in many Aboriginal communities?” “What was the function of Gregorian chant in medieval monastic religious observance? Does it have the same function today?” “What are some differences in the way the Buddha is depicted in various cultures? What are the reasons for the differences?”

F2. Social Contexts

By the end of this course, students will:

- F2.1** analyse the ways in which religious pluralism is reflected in Canadian society and culture (*e.g., demographics, government policy*)

Teacher prompt: “How does the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms encourage or discourage religious plurality?”

F2.2 evaluate the influence of various religions and belief traditions on the policies and practices of social and political institutions (e.g., the Canadian constitution, hospitals, schools)

Teacher prompts: “Why do the names of many hospitals indicate an affiliation with particular religions or belief traditions?” “How is consideration of religious beliefs expressed through the policies of your school or school board?” “How have faith-based groups influenced the development of universal health care legislation in Canada?”

F2.3 identify some common prejudices and misconceptions about various religions and belief traditions

F3. Social Challenges

By the end of this course, students will:

F3.1 explain why tensions and debates have arisen between various faith communities and society (e.g., Doukhobors, religious marriage tribunals, satyagraha, Aboriginal women of Narmada)

Teacher prompts: “How did the beliefs of the women of Narmada influence their decision to stage a non-violent protest against the construction of the Narmada Valley dam?” “Why is the legal status of religious marriage tribunals contested in Canadian courts?”

F3.2 explain how leaders from various religions and belief traditions have used religion to oppose prejudice and discrimination (e.g., Guru Nanak, Elijah Harper, Jesus of Nazareth, Muhammad, Marcus Garvey, Martin Luther King Jr., Mohandas K. Gandhi, Moses)

F3.3 evaluate the influence of prejudice on public perceptions of the practices of various religious institutions and belief traditions (e.g., common public perceptions and misconceptions related to wearing the kirpan, jihad, proselytism, First Nations’ use of tobacco and sweetgrass)

Teacher prompts: “How do media depictions of jihad reflect or perpetuate common misconceptions about jihad?” “How have misunderstandings about the function and role of the kirpan in Sikhism contributed to tension in Canadian society?” “How might efforts to discourage tobacco consumption conflict with First Nation beliefs?”

F3.4 analyse how specific laws or historical events have affected relationships between the state and groups holding particular religious beliefs (e.g., anti-conversion laws in India; the Iranian

Revolution of 1979; the French Loi no. 2004 228 on secularism and conspicuous religious symbols; restrictions on the use of the Lord’s Prayer in public institutions in Ontario; secularization in Turkey after the First World War; the status of religion under and after Soviet communism; residential schools legislation and First Nation communities in Canada)

Teacher prompts: “What was the reason for the French legislation on secularism and conspicuous religious symbols, and what response has it prompted?” “Why was the inclusion of smudging during the swearing in of Paul Martin’s cabinet a milestone in the relationship between the Canadian government and Canada’s Aboriginal people?” “How is the role of Buddhism as the state religion reflected in the relationship of the people of Thailand with their monarch?” “To what extent should elected officials in Canada allow their faith to influence how they carry out their public functions?”

F4. Religion, Civil Society, and Popular Culture

By the end of this course, students will:

F4.1 identify ways in which religious or quasi-religious references or symbols are incorporated into civil ceremonies (e.g., through flags, the national anthem, observances on Remembrance Day)

Teacher prompts: “How does the reference to God in the Canadian national anthem reflect the values of a multicultural society?” “How do Remembrance Day ceremonies employ and reflect elements of religious ritual?”

F4.2 analyse ways in which popular culture uses traditional symbols, ideas, and other elements associated with various religions and belief traditions (e.g., the use of dream catchers and crucifixes as decorative objects or fashion accessories, the use of sacred Hindu symbols in tattoos)

Teacher prompts: “Why might the use of a dream catcher as a decorative item offend First Nation people?” “Why might it be inappropriate for movie stars and popular musicians to use the crucifix as a fashion accessory?” “What are the positive and negative effects of the commercialization of yoga and of Hindu symbols and practices?”

F4.3 analyse and critique from a personal perspective ways in which elements of various religions and belief traditions are imported into popular culture